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United States Patent	12401662
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Encrypted applications verification

Abstract

Concepts and technologies disclosed herein are directed to encrypted applications verification. According to one aspect disclosed herein, a device can execute an application verification module to perform operations. The device can receive a hash function from a master security server. The hash function can be used to verify an application installed on the device. The device can apply the hash function to application code of the application to determine a hash result. The master security server can determine whether the application is verified based upon the hash result. The device can execute the application thereby generating data traffic to be sent via a network to a destination. The device can provide the data traffic to the network. A network node can receive the data traffic and can allow or deny the data traffic access to the destination based upon a command received from the master security server.

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Appl. No.:	17/564767
Filed:	December 29, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230208856 A1	Jun. 29, 2023

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04L9/40 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H04L63/1416** (20130101); **H04L63/0236** (20130101); **H04L63/1425** (20130101);
H04L63/20 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04L (63/14); H04L (63/20); H04L (63/123); H04L (63/0227); H04L (63/0236); H04L (63/1425); H04L (9/32); H04L (9/40); G06F (9/54); G06F (21/577)

USPC: 726/22

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) The majority of connected devices operate on end-to-end encryption that makes it nearly impossible for a network operator to verify the legitimacy of an application or know whether or not the application is allowed. Technologies such as iCloud® Private Relay (available from Apple Inc.) and virtual private networks (“VPNs”) functionally change Internet service providers into dumb pipes that are not privy to the data traversing their networks. These technologies can pose a major security risk for connected devices if a valid application is replaced by a malicious application. Moreover, because the encryption is end-to-end, intermediate network nodes would not know that

the malicious application was transferred within the encrypted traffic.

SUMMARY

(2) Concepts and technologies disclosed herein are directed to encrypted applications verification. According to one aspect of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein, a device can include a processor and a memory. The memory can include an application verification module comprising instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform operations. The device can receive a hash function from a master security server. The hash function can be used to verify an application installed on the device. The device can apply the hash function to application code of the application to determine a hash result. The device can provide the hash result to the master security server. The master security server can determine whether the application is verified based upon the hash result. The device can execute the application thereby generating data traffic to be sent via a network to a destination. The device can provide the data traffic to the network. A network node can receive the data traffic and can allow or deny the data traffic access to the destination based upon a command received from the master security server.

(3) In some embodiments, the master security server can periodically update the hash function. In some embodiments, the device can receive a second hash function. The second hash function can replace the hash function.

(4) In some embodiments, the second hash function can be used to verify a second application installed on the device. The device can apply the second hash function to a second application code of the second application to determine a second hash result. The device can provide the second hash result to the master security server. The master security server can determine whether the second application is verified based upon the second hash result. The device can execute the second application thereby generating second data traffic to be sent via the network to a second destination. The device can provide the second data traffic to the network. The network node can receive the second data traffic and can allow or deny the second data traffic access to the second destination based upon a second command received from the master security server.

(5) The device can generally be any computing device that is capable of executing an application via one or more processors. In some embodiments, the device is or includes an Internet of Things (“IoT”) device. In other embodiments, the device is or includes a smartphone. In still other embodiments, the device is or includes a computer.

(6) According to another aspect of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein, a master security server can include a processor and a memory. The memory can include instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform operations. In particular, the master security server can determine a hash function to verify an application installed on a device, such as an IoT device, a smartphone, or a computer. The device can have an application verification module stored thereon. The master security server can provide the hash function to the device. The application verification module can apply the hash function to application code of the application to determine a hash result. The master security server can determine whether the hash result received from the device matches a stored hash result for the application. The master security server can generate a command directed to a network node. The command can instruct the network node to allow or deny data traffic associated with the application. The master security server can then provide the command to the network node.

(7) In some embodiments, the master security server can periodically update the hash function. In some embodiments, the master security server can determine a second hash function to the device and can provide the second hash function to the device. In some embodiments, the second hash function can replace the hash function. The application verification module installed on the device can apply the second hash function to the application code of the application to determine a second hash result. In some embodiments, the second hash function can be used to verify a second application installed on the device.

(8) It should be appreciated that the above-described subject matter may be implemented as a

computer-controlled apparatus, a computer process, a computing system, or as an article of manufacture such as a computer-readable storage medium. These and various other features will be apparent from a reading of the following Detailed Description and a review of the associated drawings.

(9) Other systems, methods, and/or computer program products according to embodiments will be or become apparent to one with skill in the art upon review of the following drawings and detailed description. It is intended that all such additional systems, methods, and/or computer program products be included within this description and be within the scope of this disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating aspects of an illustrative operating environment for various concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(2) FIG. 2 is a flow diagram illustrating aspects of a method for verifying an encrypted application from the perspective of a master security server, according to an illustrative embodiment of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(3) FIG. 3 is a flow diagram illustrating aspects of a method for verifying an encrypted application from the perspective of a device, according to an illustrative embodiment of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(4) FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating an example computer system capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(5) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an example mobile device capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(6) FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating an example network capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(7) FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating a virtualized cloud architecture capable of implementing aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) The concepts and technologies disclosed herein are directed to encrypted application verification. According to one aspect disclosed herein, a network operator can ensure that a verified application is running on a device instead of a malicious application or compromised application. Devices operating on the network are ensured to run only verified applications; otherwise, data traffic to and from these devices can be blocked.

(9) While the subject matter described herein is presented in the general context of program modules that execute in conjunction with the execution of an operating system and application programs on a computer system, those skilled in the art will recognize that other implementations may be performed in combination with other types of program modules. Generally, program modules include routines, programs, components, data structures, and other types of structures that perform particular tasks or implement particular abstract data types. Moreover, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the subject matter described herein may be practiced with other computer system configurations, including hand-held devices, multiprocessor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, minicomputers, mainframe computers, and the like.

(10) Turning now to FIG. 1, an operating environment **100** in which aspects of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein can be implemented will be described. The operating environment **100** includes a user **102** who is associated with a device **104**. The device **104** can generally be any computing device that is capable of executing one or more applications **106** via one or more processors (best shown in FIGS. 4 and 5). More particularly, the device **104** can be or can include a smartphone, a tablet, a computer, a smart device (e.g., a smartwatch, a fitness device, or the like),

an IoT device, and the like. In some embodiments, the device **104** is configured the same as or similar to a computer system **400** described herein with reference to FIG. **4**. In some other embodiments, the device **104** is configured the same as or similar to a mobile device **500** described herein with reference to FIG. **5**.

(11) The device **104** can also execute an application verification module **108** to perform operations. In particular, the device **104** can receive one or more hash functions **110** from a master security server **112**. Each of the hash functions **110** can be assigned to a particular one of the applications **106** to be executed by the device **104**. The application verification module **108** can apply the hash functions **110** to application code **114** associated with the applications **106** to determine hash results **116**. The device **104** can then send the hash results **116** to the master security server **112**. The master security server **112**, in turn, can compare the hash results **116** with latest hash results **118**. The master security server **112** can determine the latest hash results **118** by applying the hash functions **110** to latest application versions **120** of the applications **106** installed on the device **104**. The latest application versions **120** and the latest hash results **118** can be stored, for example, in a verified application database **122**. The master security server **112** can obtain the latest application versions **120** from an application source **124**, such as a website or application marketplace.

(12) In the illustrated example, the device **104** has one or more verified applications **126** and one or more unverified applications **128**. A verified application **126** is an application **106** for which the hash result **116** matches the latest hash result **118** stored on the master security server **112**. An unverified application **128** is an application for which the hash result **116** does not match the latest hash result **118** stored on the master security server **112**. The master security server **112** can provide a notification **130** to the device **104** to warn the device **104** that an unverified application **128** is installed. The user **102** can then take the steps necessary to delete the unverified application **128** from the device **104**. Alternatively, the notification **130** can include instructions for the device **104** to automatically delete the unverified application **128**.

(13) The applications **106** can generate data traffic **132** directed to one or more destinations **134**. The destinations **134** can be or can include smartphones, tablets, computers, smart devices (e.g., smartwatches, fitness devices, or the like), IoT devices, and the like. The destinations **134** can be or can include websites, web servers, application servers, cloud networks, and the like. The destinations **134** can provide application data **133** to the application(s) **106** executed by the device **104**. For example, a video streaming application can request streaming video data from the destination(s) **134**, such as a video server operating in a data center. The application data **133** can include any other data exchanged between the device **104** and the destination(s) **134**. In some embodiments, the destinations **134** are configured the same as or similar to a computer system **400** described herein with reference to FIG. **4**. In some other embodiments, the destinations **134** are configured the same as or similar to a mobile device **500** described herein with reference to FIG. **5**.

(14) The applications **106** can attempt to send the data traffic **132** to the destination(s) **134** via one or more networks **136**. The network(s) **136** can be or can include one or more private networks, one or more public networks, one or more public land mobile networks (“PLMNs”), one or more packet data networks (“PDNs”) (e.g., the Internet), one or more wireless local area networks (“WLANs”), one or more wireless wide area networks (“WWANs”), combinations thereof, and/or the like. The network(s) **136** can be embodied, at least in part, as a network **600** illustrated and described herein with reference to FIG. **6**. The network(s) **136** can include one or more network nodes, such as, in the illustrated example, one or more edge nodes **138** and one or more intermediate network nodes **140**. The edge nodes **138** can be or can include gateways, firewalls, edge routers, and the like. The intermediate network nodes **140** can be or can include switches, routers, and the like.

(15) The master security server **112** can generate commands **142** directed to the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network nodes **140**. The commands **142** can instruct the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network nodes **140** to allow or deny the data traffic **132** access to the

destination(s) **134**. In this manner, the master security server **112** can eliminate the distribution of the data traffic **132** that is associated with the unverified application(s) **128** to other devices such as the destination(s) **134**.

(16) Turning now to FIG. **2**, a flow diagram illustrating aspects of a method **200** for verifying encrypted applications **106** from the perspective of the master security server **112** will be described, according to an illustrative embodiment. It should be understood that the operations of the method disclosed herein is not necessarily presented in any particular order and that performance of some or all of the operations in an alternative order(s) is possible and is contemplated. The operations have been presented in the demonstrated order for ease of description and illustration. Operations may be added, omitted, and/or performed simultaneously, without departing from the scope of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(17) It also should be understood that the method disclosed herein can be ended at any time and need not be performed in its entirety. Some or all operations of the method, and/or substantially equivalent operations, can be performed by execution of computer-readable instructions included on a computer storage media, as defined herein. The term “computer-readable instructions,” and variants thereof, as used herein, is used expansively to include routines, applications, application modules, program modules, programs, components, data structures, algorithms, and the like. Computer-readable instructions can be implemented on various system configurations including single-processor or multiprocessor systems, minicomputers, mainframe computers, personal computers, hand-held computing devices, microprocessor-based, programmable consumer electronics, combinations thereof, and the like.

(18) Thus, it should be appreciated that the logical operations described herein are implemented (1) as a sequence of computer implemented acts or program modules running on a computing system and/or (2) as interconnected machine logic circuits or circuit modules within the computing system. The implementation is a matter of choice dependent on the performance and other requirements of the computing system. Accordingly, the logical operations described herein are referred to variously as states, operations, structural devices, acts, or modules. These states, operations, structural devices, acts, and modules may be implemented in software, in firmware, in special purpose digital logic, and any combination thereof. As used herein, the phrase “cause a processor to perform operations” and variants thereof is used to refer to causing a processor of a computing system or device, or a portion thereof, to perform one or more operations, and/or causing the processor to direct other components of the computing system or device to perform one or more of the operations.

(19) For purposes of illustrating and describing the concepts of the present disclosure, operations of the methods disclosed herein are described as being performed alone or in combination via execution of one or more software modules, and/or other software/firmware components described herein. It should be understood that additional and/or alternative devices and/or network nodes can provide the functionality described herein via execution of one or more modules, applications, and/or other software. Thus, the illustrated embodiments are illustrative, and should not be viewed as being limiting in any way.

(20) The method **200** begins and proceeds to operation **202**. At operation **202**, the master security server **112** connects to the application verification module **108** installed on the device **104**. From operation **202**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **204**. At operation **204**, the master security server **112** determines a hash function **110** to be used for verifying an application **106** installed on the device **104**. From operation **204**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **206**. At operation **206**, the master security server **112** provides the hash function **110** to the device **104**. From operation **206**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **208**. At operation **208**, the master security server **112** receives the hash result **116** from the device **104**.

(21) From operation **208**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **210**. At operation **210**, the master security server **112** determines whether the hash result **116** received from the device **104** matches

the latest hash result **118** stored for the application **106**. If the master security server **112** determines, at operation **210**, that the hash result **116** received from the device **104** matches the latest hash result **118** stored for the application **106**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **212**. At operation **212**, the master security server **112** generates the command(s) **142** directed to the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network node(s) **140**, to instruct these network node(s) to allow the data traffic **132** associated with the application **106**. From operation **212**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **214**. At operation **214**, the master security server **112** sends the command(s) **142** to the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network node(s) **140**. From operation **214**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **216**. At operation **216**, the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network node(s) **140** allow or deny the data traffic **132** associated with the application **106** in accordance with the command(s) **142**. From operation **216**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **218**. The method **200** can end at operation **218**.

(22) Returning to operation **210**, if the master security server **112** determines that the hash result **116** received from the device **104** does not match the latest hash result **118** for the application **106**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **220**. At operation **220**, the master security server **112** generates the command(s) **142** directed to the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network node(s) **140** to instruct these network node(s) to deny the data traffic **132** associated with the application **106**. From operation **220**, the method **200** proceeds to operation **214** and the method **200** proceeds as described above.

(23) Turning now to FIG. **3**, a flow diagram illustrating aspects of a method **300** for verifying encrypted applications **106** from the perspective of the device **104** will be described, according to an illustrative embodiment. The method **300** begins and proceeds to operation **302**. At operation **302**, the application verification module **108** is installed on the device **104**. In some embodiments, the application verification module **108** can be installed by a network operator prior to the device **104** being offered for sale. In some embodiments, the application verification module **108** can be installed by the device manufacturer. In some embodiments, the application verification module **108** can be part of a firmware of the device **104**. In some embodiments, the application verification module **108** can be part of an operating system of the device **104**.

(24) From operation **302**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **304**. At operation **304**, the device **104** connects to the master security server **112**. From operation **304**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **306**. At operation **306**, the device **104** receives the hash function **110** from the master security server **112**. From operation **306**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **308**. At operation **308**, the device **104** applies the hash function **110** to the application code **114** to determine the hash result **116**. From operation **308**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **310**. At operation **310**, the device **104** provides the hash result **116** to the master security server **112**.

(25) From operation **310**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **312**. At operation **312**, the device **104** executes the application **106** thereby generating data traffic **132**. From operation **312**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **314**. At operation **314**, the device **104** provides the data traffic **132** to the network **136**. From operation **314**, the edge node(s) **138** and/or the intermediate network node(s) **140** allow or deny the data traffic **132** associated with the application **106** in accordance with the command(s) **142** received from the master security server **112**. From operation **316**, the method **300** proceeds to operation **318**. The method **300** can end at operation **318**.

(26) Turning now to FIG. **4**, a block diagram illustrating a computer system **400** configured to provide the functionality described herein in accordance with various embodiments. In some embodiments, the device **104** can be configured the same as or similar to the computer system **400**. In some embodiments, the master security server **112** can be configured the same as or similar to the computer system **400**. In some embodiments, the destination(s) **134** can be configured the same as or similar to the computer system **400**.

(27) The computer system **400** includes a processing unit **402**, a memory **404**, one or more user interface devices **406**, one or more input/output (“I/O”) devices **408**, and one or more network

devices **410**, each of which is operatively connected to a system bus **412**. The bus **412** enables bi-directional communication between the processing unit **402**, the memory **404**, the user interface devices **406**, the I/O devices **408**, and the network devices **410**.

(28) The processing unit **402** may be a standard central processor that performs arithmetic and logical operations, a more specific purpose programmable logic controller (“PLC”), a programmable gate array, or other type of processor known to those skilled in the art and suitable for controlling the operation of the server computer. The processing unit **402** can be a single processing unit or a multiple processing unit that includes more than one processing component. Processing units are generally known, and therefore are not described in further detail herein.

(29) The memory **404** communicates with the processing unit **402** via the system bus **412**. The memory **404** can include a single memory component or multiple memory components. In some embodiments, the memory **404** is operatively connected to a memory controller (not shown) that enables communication with the processing unit **402** via the system bus **412**. The memory **404** includes an operating system **414** and one or more program modules **416**. The operating system **414** can include, but is not limited to, members of the WINDOWS, WINDOWS CE, and/or WINDOWS MOBILE families of operating systems from MICROSOFT CORPORATION, the LINUX family of operating systems, the SYMBIAN family of operating systems from SYMBIAN LIMITED, the BREW family of operating systems from QUALCOMM CORPORATION, the MAC OSX, iOS, and/or families of operating systems from APPLE CORPORATION, the FREEBSD family of operating systems, the SOLARIS family of operating systems from ORACLE CORPORATION, other operating systems, and the like.

(30) The program modules **416** may include various software and/or program modules described herein. The program modules **416** can include the application verification module **108** in an embodiment of the device **104** configured the same as or similar to the computer system **400**. In some embodiments, multiple implementations of the computer system **400** can be used, wherein each implementation is configured to execute one or more of the program modules **416**. The program modules **416** and/or other programs can be embodied in computer-readable media containing instructions that, when executed by the processing unit **402**, perform the method **200** and/or the method **300** described herein. According to embodiments, the program modules **416** may be embodied in hardware, software, firmware, or any combination thereof. The memory **404** also can be configured to store the verified application database **122**, including the latest application versions **120** and the latest hash results **118**, the hash functions **110**, the application code **114**, the applications **106**, other data disclosed herein, or a combination thereof.

(31) By way of example, and not limitation, computer-readable media may include any available computer storage media or communication media that can be accessed by the computer system **400**. Communication media includes computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and includes any delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics changed or set in a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wired media such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared and other wireless media. Combinations of any of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(32) Computer storage media includes volatile and non-volatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, random access memory (“RAM”), read-only memory (“ROM”), Erasable Programmable ROM (“EPROM”), Electrically Erasable Programmable ROM (“EEPROM”), flash memory or other solid state memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (“DVD”), or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage

or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by the computer system **400**. In the claims, the phrase “computer storage medium,” “computer-readable storage medium,” and variations thereof does not include waves or signals per se and/or communication media, and therefore should be construed as being directed to “non-transitory” media only.

(33) The user interface devices **406** may include one or more devices with which a user accesses the computer system **400**. The user interface devices **406** may include, but are not limited to, computers, servers, personal digital assistants, cellular phones, or any suitable computing devices. The I/O devices **408** enable a user to interface with the program modules **416**. In one embodiment, the I/O devices **408** are operatively connected to an I/O controller (not shown) that enables communication with the processing unit **402** via the system bus **412**. The I/O devices **408** may include one or more input devices, such as, but not limited to, a keyboard, a mouse, or an electronic stylus. Further, the I/O devices **408** may include one or more output devices, such as, but not limited to, a display or printer.

(34) The network devices **410** enable the computer system **400** to communicate with other networks or remote systems via one or more network(s) **418**, such as the network(s) **136** shown in FIG. **1**. Examples of the network devices **410** include, but are not limited to, a modem, a radio frequency (“RF”) or infrared (“IR”) transceiver, a telephonic interface, a bridge, a router, or a network card. The network **418** may include a wireless network such as, but not limited to, a Wireless Local Area Network (“WLAN”) such as a WI-FI network, a Wireless Wide Area Network (“WWAN”), a Wireless Personal Area Network (“WPAN”) such as BLUETOOTH, a Wireless Metropolitan Area Network (“WMAN”) such as a WiMAX network, or a cellular network. Alternatively, the network **418** may be a wired network such as, but not limited to, a Wide Area Network (“WAN”) such as the Internet, a Local Area Network (“LAN”) such as the Ethernet, a wired Personal Area Network (“PAN”), or a wired Metropolitan Area Network (“MAN”).

(35) Turning now to FIG. **5**, an illustrative mobile device **500** and components thereof will be described. In some embodiments, the device **104** can be configured the same as or similar to the mobile device **500**. In some embodiments, the master security server **112** can be configured the same as or similar to the mobile device **500**. In some embodiments, the destination(s) **134** can be configured the same as or similar to the mobile device **500**. While connections are not shown between the various components illustrated in FIG. **5**, it should be understood that some, none, or all of the components illustrated in FIG. **5** can be configured to interact with one another to carry out various device functions. In some embodiments, the components are arranged so as to communicate via one or more busses (not shown). Thus, it should be understood that FIG. **5** and the following description are intended to provide a general understanding of a suitable environment in which various aspects of embodiments can be implemented, and should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(36) As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the mobile device **500** can include a display **502** for displaying data. According to various embodiments, the display **502** can be configured to display various GUI elements, text, images, video, virtual keypads and/or keyboards, messaging data, notification messages, metadata, Internet content, device status, time, date, calendar data, device preferences, map and location data, combinations thereof, and/or the like. The mobile device **500** can also include a processor **504** and a memory or other data storage device (“memory”) **506**. The processor **504** can be configured to process data and/or can execute computer-executable instructions stored in the memory **506**. The computer-executable instructions executed by the processor **504** can include, for example, an operating system **508**, one or more applications **510**, other computer-executable instructions stored in the memory **506**, or the like. The applications **510** can include the applications **106** (shown in FIG. **1**) and the application verification module **108**. In some embodiments, the applications **510** can also include a UI application (not illustrated in FIG. **5**). The memory **506** can also store data **512**, such as the verified application database **122**, including the

latest application versions **120** and the latest hash results **118**, the hash functions **110**, the application code **114**, the application data **133**, other data disclosed herein, or a combination thereof.

(37) The UI application can interface with the operating system **508** to facilitate user interaction with functionality and/or data stored at the mobile device **500** and/or stored elsewhere. In some embodiments, the operating system **508** can include a member of the SYMBIAN OS family of operating systems from SYMBIAN LIMITED, a member of the WINDOWS MOBILE OS and/or WINDOWS PHONE OS families of operating systems from MICROSOFT CORPORATION, a member of the PALM WEBOS family of operating systems from HEWLETT PACKARD CORPORATION, a member of the BLACKBERRY OS family of operating systems from RESEARCH IN MOTION LIMITED, a member of the IOS family of operating systems from APPLE INC., a member of the ANDROID OS family of operating systems from GOOGLE LLC, and/or other operating systems. These operating systems are merely illustrative of some contemplated operating systems that may be used in accordance with various embodiments of the concepts and technologies described herein and therefore should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(38) The UI application can be executed by the processor **504** to aid a user in entering/deleting data, entering and setting user IDs and passwords for device access, configuring settings, manipulating content and/or settings, multimode interaction, interacting with other applications **510**, and otherwise facilitating user interaction with the operating system **508**, the applications **510**, and/or other types or instances of data **512** that can be stored at the mobile device **500**.

(39) The applications **510**, the data **512**, and/or portions thereof can be stored in the memory **506** and/or in a firmware **514**, and can be executed by the processor **504**. The firmware **514** can also store code for execution during device power up and power down operations. It can be appreciated that the firmware **514** can be stored in a volatile or non-volatile data storage device including, but not limited to, the memory **506** and/or a portion thereof.

(40) The mobile device **500** can also include an input/output (“I/O”) interface **516**. The I/O interface **516** can be configured to support the input/output of data such as location information, presence status information, user IDs, passwords, and application initiation (start-up) requests. In some embodiments, the I/O interface **516** can include a hardwire connection such as a universal serial bus (“USB”) port, a mini-USB port, a micro-USB port, an audio jack, a PS2 port, an IEEE 1394 (“FIREWIRE”) port, a serial port, a parallel port, an Ethernet (RJ45) port, an RJ11 port, a proprietary port, combinations thereof, or the like. In some embodiments, the mobile device **500** can be configured to synchronize with another device to transfer content to and/or from the mobile device **500**. In some embodiments, the mobile device **500** can be configured to receive updates to one or more of the applications **510** via the I/O interface **516**, though this is not necessarily the case. In some embodiments, the I/O interface **516** accepts I/O devices such as keyboards, keypads, mice, interface tethers, printers, plotters, external storage, touch/multi-touch screens, touch pads, trackballs, joysticks, microphones, remote control devices, displays, projectors, medical equipment (e.g., stethoscopes, heart monitors, and other health metric monitors), modems, routers, external power sources, docking stations, combinations thereof, and the like. It should be appreciated that the I/O interface **516** may be used for communications between the mobile device **500** and a network device or local device.

(41) The mobile device **500** can also include a communications component **518**. The communications component **518** can be configured to interface with the processor **504** to facilitate wired and/or wireless communications with one or more networks, such as the network **418**, the Internet, or some combination thereof. In some embodiments, the communications component **518** includes a multimode communications subsystem for facilitating communications via the cellular network and one or more other networks.

(42) The communications component **518**, in some embodiments, includes one or more

transceivers. The one or more transceivers, if included, can be configured to communicate over the same and/or different wireless technology standards with respect to one another. For example, in some embodiments, one or more of the transceivers of the communications component **518** may be configured to communicate using Global System for Mobile communications (“GSM”), Code-Division Multiple Access (“CDMA”) CDMAONE, CDMA2000, Long-Term Evolution (“LTE”) LTE, and various other 2G, 2.5G, 3G, 4G, 4.5G, 5G, and greater generation technology standards. Moreover, the communications component **518** may facilitate communications over various channel access methods (which may or may not be used by the aforementioned standards) including, but not limited to, Time-Division Multiple Access (“TDMA”), Frequency-Division Multiple Access (“FDMA”), Wideband CDMA (“W-CDMA”), Orthogonal Frequency-Division Multiple Access (“OFDMA”), Space-Division Multiple Access (“SDMA”), and the like.

(43) In addition, the communications component **518** may facilitate data communications using General Packet Radio Service (“GPRS”), Enhanced Data services for Global Evolution (“EDGE”), the High-Speed Packet Access (“HSPA”) protocol family including High-Speed Downlink Packet Access (“HSDPA”), Enhanced Uplink (“EUL”) (also referred to as High-Speed Uplink Packet Access (“HSUPA”), HSPA+, and various other current and future wireless data access standards. In the illustrated embodiment, the communications component **518** can include a first transceiver (“TxRx”) **520A** that can operate in a first communications mode (e.g., GSM). The communications component **518** can also include an N.sup.th transceiver (“TxRx”) **520N** that can operate in a second communications mode relative to the first transceiver **520A** (e.g., UMTS). While two transceivers **520A-520N** (hereinafter collectively and/or generically referred to as “transceivers **520**”) are shown in FIG. 5, it should be appreciated that less than two, two, and/or more than two transceivers **520** can be included in the communications component **518**.

(44) The communications component **518** can also include an alternative transceiver (“Alt TxRx”) **522** for supporting other types and/or standards of communications. According to various contemplated embodiments, the alternative transceiver **522** can communicate using various communications technologies such as, for example, WI-FI, WIMAX, BLUETOOTH, infrared, infrared data association (“IRDA”), near field communications (“NFC”), other RF technologies, combinations thereof, and the like. In some embodiments, the communications component **518** can also facilitate reception from terrestrial radio networks, digital satellite radio networks, internet-based radio service networks, combinations thereof, and the like. The communications component **518** can process data from a network such as the Internet, an intranet, a broadband network, a WI-FI hotspot, an Internet service provider (“ISP”), a digital subscriber line (“DSL”) provider, a broadband provider, combinations thereof, or the like.

(45) The mobile device **500** can also include one or more sensors **524**. The sensors **524** can include temperature sensors, light sensors, air quality sensors, movement sensors, accelerometers, magnetometers, gyroscopes, infrared sensors, orientation sensors, noise sensors, microphones proximity sensors, combinations thereof, and/or the like. Additionally, audio capabilities for the mobile device **500** may be provided by an audio I/O component **526**. The audio I/O component **526** of the mobile device **500** can include one or more speakers for the output of audio signals, one or more microphones for the collection and/or input of audio signals, and/or other audio input and/or output devices.

(46) The illustrated mobile device **500** can also include a subscriber identity module (“SIM”) system **528**. The SIM system **528** can include a universal SIM (“USIM”), a universal integrated circuit card (“UICC”) and/or other identity devices. The SIM system **528** can include and/or can be connected to or inserted into an interface such as a slot interface **530**. In some embodiments, the slot interface **530** can be configured to accept insertion of other identity cards or modules for accessing various types of networks. Additionally, or alternatively, the slot interface **530** can be configured to accept multiple subscriber identity cards. Because other devices and/or modules for identifying users and/or the mobile device **500** are contemplated, it should be understood that these

embodiments are illustrative, and should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(47) The mobile device **500** can also include an image capture and processing system **532** (“image system”). The image system **532** can be configured to capture or otherwise obtain photos, videos, and/or other visual information. As such, the image system **532** can include cameras, lenses, charge-coupled devices (“CCDs”), combinations thereof, or the like. The mobile device **500** may also include a video system **534**. The video system **534** can be configured to capture, process, record, modify, and/or store video content. Photos and videos obtained using the image system **532** and the video system **534**, respectively, may be added as message content to an MMS message, email message, and sent to another device. The video and/or photo content can also be shared with other devices via various types of data transfers via wired and/or wireless communication devices as described herein.

(48) The mobile device **500** can also include one or more location components **536**. The location components **536** can be configured to send and/or receive signals to determine a geographic location of the mobile device **500**. According to various embodiments, the location components **536** can send and/or receive signals from global positioning system (“GPS”) devices, assisted-GPS (“A-GPS”) devices, WI-FI/WIMAX and/or cellular network triangulation data, combinations thereof, and the like. The location component **536** can also be configured to communicate with the communications component **518** to retrieve triangulation data for determining a location of the mobile device **500**. In some embodiments, the location component **536** can interface with cellular network nodes, telephone lines, satellites, location transmitters and/or beacons, wireless network transmitters and receivers, combinations thereof, and the like. In some embodiments, the location component **536** can include and/or can communicate with one or more of the sensors **524** such as a compass, an accelerometer, and/or a gyroscope to determine the orientation of the mobile device **500**. Using the location component **536**, the mobile device **500** can generate and/or receive data to identify its geographic location, or to transmit data used by other devices to determine the location of the mobile device **500**. The location component **536** may include multiple components for determining the location and/or orientation of the mobile device **500**.

(49) The illustrated mobile device **500** can also include a power source **538**. The power source **538** can include one or more batteries, power supplies, power cells, and/or other power subsystems including alternating current (“AC”) and/or direct current (“DC”) power devices. The power source **538** can also interface with an external power system or charging equipment via a power I/O component **540**. Because the mobile device **500** can include additional and/or alternative components, the above embodiment should be understood as being illustrative of one possible operating environment for various embodiments of the concepts and technologies described herein. The described embodiment of the mobile device **500** is illustrative, and should not be construed as being limiting in any way.

(50) As used herein, communication media includes computer-executable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and includes any delivery media. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics changed or set in a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wired media such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared, and other wireless media. Combinations of any of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(51) By way of example, and not limitation, computer storage media may include volatile and non-volatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-executable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data. For example, computer media includes, but is not limited to, RAM, ROM, EPROM, EEPROM, flash memory or other solid state memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (“DVD”), HD-DVD, BLU-RAY, or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape,

magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store the desired information and which can be accessed by the mobile device **500** or other devices or computers described herein, such as the computer system **400** described above with reference to FIG. **4**. In the claims, the phrase “computer storage medium,” “computer-readable storage medium,” and variations thereof does not include waves or signals per se and/or communication media, and therefore should be construed as being directed to “non-transitory” media only.

(52) Encoding the software modules presented herein also may transform the physical structure of the computer-readable media presented herein. The specific transformation of physical structure may depend on various factors, in different implementations of this description. Examples of such factors may include, but are not limited to, the technology used to implement the computer-readable media, whether the computer-readable media is characterized as primary or secondary storage, and the like. For example, if the computer-readable media is implemented as semiconductor-based memory, the software disclosed herein may be encoded on the computer-readable media by transforming the physical state of the semiconductor memory. For example, the software may transform the state of transistors, capacitors, or other discrete circuit elements constituting the semiconductor memory. The software also may transform the physical state of such components in order to store data thereupon.

(53) As another example, the computer-readable media disclosed herein may be implemented using magnetic or optical technology. In such implementations, the software presented herein may transform the physical state of magnetic or optical media, when the software is encoded therein. These transformations may include altering the magnetic characteristics of particular locations within given magnetic media. These transformations also may include altering the physical features or characteristics of particular locations within given optical media, to change the optical characteristics of those locations. Other transformations of physical media are possible without departing from the scope and spirit of the present description, with the foregoing examples provided only to facilitate this discussion.

(54) In light of the above, it should be appreciated that many types of physical transformations may take place in the mobile device **500** in order to store and execute the software components presented herein. It is also contemplated that the mobile device **500** may not include all of the components shown in FIG. **5**, may include other components that are not explicitly shown in FIG. **5**, or may utilize an architecture completely different than that shown in FIG. **5**.

(55) Turning now to FIG. **6**, details of a network **600** are illustrated, according to an illustrative embodiment. In some embodiments, the network(s) **136** shown in FIG. **1** and/or the network **418** shown in FIG. **4** can be configured the same as or similar to the network **600**. The network **600** includes a cellular network **602**, a packet data network **604**, and a circuit switched network **606** (e.g., a public switched telephone network). The cellular network **602** includes various components such as, but not limited to, base transceiver stations (“BTSS”), Node-Bs or e-Node-Bs, base station controllers (“BSCs”), radio network controllers (“RNCs”), mobile switching centers (“MSCs”), mobility management entities (“MMEs”), short message service centers (“SMSCs”), multimedia messaging service centers (“MMSCs”), home location registers (“HLRs”), home subscriber servers (“HSSs”), visitor location registers (“VLRs”), charging platforms, billing platforms, voicemail platforms, GPRS core network components, location service nodes, and the like. The cellular network **602** also includes radios and nodes for receiving and transmitting voice, data, and combinations thereof to and from radio transceivers, networks, the packet data network **604**, and the circuit switched network **606**.

(56) A mobile communications device **608**, such as, for example, the device **104**, the destination(s) **134**, the mobile device **500**, a cellular telephone, a user equipment, a mobile terminal, a PDA, a laptop computer, a handheld computer, and combinations thereof, can be operatively connected to the cellular network **602**. The mobile communications device **608** can be configured similar to or the same as the mobile device **500** described above with reference to FIG. **5**.

(57) The cellular network **602** can be configured as a GSM network and can provide data communications via GPRS and/or EDGE. Additionally, or alternatively, the cellular network **602** can be configured as a 3G Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (“UMTS”) network and can provide data communications via the HSPA protocol family, for example, HSDPA, EUL, and HSPA+. The cellular network **602** also is compatible with mobile communications standards such as LTE, or the like, as well as evolved and future mobile standards.

(58) The packet data network **604** includes various systems, devices, servers, computers, databases, and other devices in communication with one another, as is generally known. The device **104**, the master security server **112**, the destinations **134**, the edge node(s) **138**, the intermediate network node(s) **140**, or some combination thereof can communicate with each other via the packet data network **604**. In some embodiments, the packet data network **604** is or includes one or more WI-FI networks, each of which can include one or more WI-FI access points, routers, switches, and other WI-FI network components. The packet data network **604** devices are accessible via one or more network links. The servers often store various files that are provided to a requesting device such as, for example, a computer, a terminal, a smartphone, or the like. Typically, the requesting device includes software for executing a web page in a format readable by the browser or other software. Other files and/or data may be accessible via “links” in the retrieved files, as is generally known. In some embodiments, the packet data network **604** includes or is in communication with the Internet. The circuit switched network **606** includes various hardware and software for providing circuit switched communications. The circuit switched network **606** may include, or may be, what is often referred to as a plain old telephone system (“POTS”). The functionality of a circuit switched network **606** or other circuit-switched network are generally known and will not be described herein in detail.

(59) The illustrated cellular network **602** is shown in communication with the packet data network **604** and a circuit switched network **606**, though it should be appreciated that this is not necessarily the case. One or more Internet-capable systems/devices **610** such as the device(s) **104**, the master security server **112**, the destination(s) **134**, a laptop, a portable device, or another suitable device, can communicate with one or more cellular networks **602**, and devices connected thereto, through the packet data network **604**. It also should be appreciated that the Internet-capable device **610** can communicate with the packet data network **604** through the circuit switched network **606**, the cellular network **602**, and/or via other networks (not illustrated).

(60) As illustrated, a communications device **612**, for example, a telephone, facsimile machine, modem, computer, or the like, can be in communication with the circuit switched network **606**, and therethrough to the packet data network **604** and/or the cellular network **602**. It should be appreciated that the communications device **612** can be an Internet-capable device, and can be substantially similar to the Internet-capable device **610**.

(61) Turning now to FIG. 7, a block diagram illustrating an example virtualized cloud architecture **700** and components thereof will be described, according to an exemplary embodiment. In some embodiments, the virtualized cloud architecture **700** can be utilized to implement, at least in part, the master security server **112**, the network(s) **136**, the edge node(s) **138**, the intermediate network node(s) **140**, the destination(s) **134**, or a portion thereof. The virtualized cloud architecture **700** is a shared infrastructure that can support multiple services and network applications. The illustrated virtualized cloud architecture **700** includes a hardware resource layer **702**, a control layer **704**, a virtual resource layer **706**, and an application layer **708** that work together to perform operations as will be described in detail herein.

(62) The hardware resource layer **702** provides hardware resources, which, in the illustrated embodiment, include one or more compute resources **710**, one or more memory resources **712**, and one or more other resources **714**. The compute resource(s) **710** can include one or more hardware components that perform computations to process data, and/or to execute computer-executable instructions of one or more application programs, operating systems, and/or other software. The

compute resources **710** can include one or more central processing units (“CPUs”) configured with one or more processing cores. The compute resources **710** can include one or more graphics processing unit (“GPU”) configured to accelerate operations performed by one or more CPUs, and/or to perform computations to process data, and/or to execute computer-executable instructions of one or more application programs, operating systems, and/or other software that may or may not include instructions particular to graphics computations. In some embodiments, the compute resources **710** can include one or more discrete GPUs. In some other embodiments, the compute resources **710** can include CPU and GPU components that are configured in accordance with a co-processing CPU/GPU computing model, wherein the sequential part of an application executes on the CPU and the computationally-intensive part is accelerated by the GPU. The compute resources **710** can include one or more system-on-chip (“SoC”) components along with one or more other components, including, for example, one or more of the memory resources **712**, and/or one or more of the other resources **714**. In some embodiments, the compute resources **710** can be or can include one or more SNAPDRAGON SoCs, available from QUALCOMM; one or more TEGRA SoCs, available from NVIDIA; one or more HUMMINGBIRD SoCs, available from SAMSUNG; one or more Open Multimedia Application Platform (“OMAP”) SoCs, available from TEXAS INSTRUMENTS; one or more customized versions of any of the above SoCs; and/or one or more proprietary SoCs. The compute resources **710** can be or can include one or more hardware components architected in accordance with an advanced reduced instruction set computing (“RISC”) machine (“ARM”) architecture, available for license from ARM HOLDINGS. Alternatively, the compute resources **710** can be or can include one or more hardware components architected in accordance with an x86 architecture, such an architecture available from INTEL CORPORATION of Mountain View, California, and others. Those skilled in the art will appreciate the implementation of the compute resources **710** can utilize various computation architectures, and as such, the compute resources **710** should not be construed as being limited to any particular computation architecture or combination of computation architectures, including those explicitly disclosed herein.

(63) The memory resource(s) **712** can include one or more hardware components that perform storage operations, including temporary or permanent storage operations. In some embodiments, the memory resource(s) **712** include volatile and/or non-volatile memory implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data disclosed herein. In implementations of the master security server **112** on the virtualized cloud architecture **700**, the memory resource(s) **712** can store the verified application database, including the latest application versions and the latest application hashes, the hash functions, the application data, or a combination thereof.

(64) Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, random access memory (“RAM”), read-only memory (“ROM”), Erasable Programmable ROM (“EPROM”), Electrically Erasable Programmable ROM (“EEPROM”), flash memory or other solid state memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (“DVD”), or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store data and which can be accessed by the compute resources **710**.

(65) The other resource(s) **714** can include any other hardware resources that can be utilized by the compute resources(s) **710** and/or the memory resource(s) **712** to perform operations described herein. The other resource(s) **714** can include one or more input and/or output processors (e.g., network interface controller or wireless radio), one or more modems, one or more codec chipset, one or more pipeline processors, one or more fast Fourier transform (“FFT”) processors, one or more digital signal processors (“DSPs”), one or more speech synthesizers, and/or the like.

(66) The hardware resources operating within the hardware resource layer **702** can be virtualized by one or more virtual machine monitors (“VMMs”) **716A-716N** (also known as “hypervisors;” hereinafter “VMMs **716**”) operating within the control layer **704** to manage one or more virtual

resources that reside in the virtual resource layer **706**. The VMMs **716** can be or can include software, firmware, and/or hardware that alone or in combination with other software, firmware, and/or hardware, manages one or more virtual resources operating within the virtual resource layer **706**.

(67) The virtual resources operating within the virtual resource layer **706** can include abstractions of at least a portion of the compute resources **710**, the memory resources **712**, the other resources **714**, or any combination thereof. These abstractions are referred to herein as virtual machines (“VMs”). In the illustrated embodiment, the virtual resource layer **706** includes VMs **718A-718N** (hereinafter “VMs **718**”). Each of the VMs **718** can execute one or more applications **720A-720N** in the application layer **708**.

(68) Based on the foregoing, it should be appreciated that aspects of encrypted application verification have been disclosed herein. Although the subject matter presented herein has been described in language specific to computer structural features, methodological and transformative acts, specific computing machinery, and computer-readable media, it is to be understood that the concepts and technologies disclosed herein are not necessarily limited to the specific features, acts, or media described herein. Rather, the specific features, acts and mediums are disclosed as example forms of implementing the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

(69) The subject matter described above is provided by way of illustration only and should not be construed as limiting. Various modifications and changes may be made to the subject matter described herein without following the example embodiments and applications illustrated and described, and without departing from the true spirit and scope of the embodiments of the concepts and technologies disclosed herein.

Claims

1. A method comprising: receiving, by a device comprising a processor executing an application verification module, a hash function from a master security server, wherein the hash function is used to verify an application installed on the device; applying, by the device, the hash function to application code of the application to determine a hash result; providing, by the device, the hash result to the master security server, wherein the master security server determines whether the application is verified by comparing the hash result to a stored hash result determined, by the master security server, by applying the hash function to a latest version of the application stored on the master security server; in response to a determination by the master security server that the application is unverified, receiving, by the device, a notification from the master security server, wherein the notification comprises instructions for the device to automatically delete the application, and wherein the master security server sends a command to a network node instructing the network node to deny data traffic originating from the application to a destination; and in response to the notification, automatically deleting, by the device, the application from the device.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising receiving, by the device, a second hash function from the master security server.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the second hash function replaces the hash function.
4. The method of claim 2, wherein the second hash function is used to verify a second application installed on the device, and wherein the method further comprises: applying, by the device, the second hash function to second application code of the second application to determine a second hash result; providing, by the device, the second hash result to the master security server, wherein the master security server determines whether the second application is verified based upon the second hash result; executing, by the device via the processor, the second application thereby generating data traffic to be sent via a network to a destination; and providing, by the device, the data traffic generated by the second application to the network, wherein a network node receives the data traffic generated by the second application and allows or denies the data traffic generated

by the second application access to the destination based upon a command associated with the second application received from the master security server.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the hash function is periodically updated by the master security server.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the device comprises an Internet of Things device, a smartphone, or a computer.

7. A method comprising: determining, by a master security server comprising a processor, a hash function to verify an application installed on a device, wherein the device also has an application verification module installed thereon; providing, by the master security server, the hash function to the device, whereby the application verification module applies the hash function to application code of the application to determine a hash result; comparing, by the master security server, the hash result to a stored hash result determined, by the master security server, by applying the hash function to a latest version of the application stored on the master security server to determine, by the master security server, whether the hash result received from the device matches the stored hash result for the latest version of the application; in response to determining that the hash result received from the device does not match the stored hash result for the latest version of the application, generating, by the master security server, a command directed to a network node, wherein the command instructs the network node to deny data traffic originating from the application to a destination, and generating, by the master security server, a notification directed to the device, wherein the notification instructs the device to automatically delete the application installed on the device from the device; and providing, by the master security server, the notification to the device.

8. The method of claim 7, further comprising: determining, by the master security server, a second hash function; and providing, by the master security server, the second hash function to the device.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the second hash function replaces the hash function, whereby the application verification module applies the second hash function to the application code of the application to determine a second hash result.

10. The method of claim 8, wherein the second hash function is used to verify a second application installed on the device.

11. The method of claim 7, further comprising periodically updating the hash function.

12. A computer-readable storage medium comprising computer-executable instructions that, when executed by a processor of a device, cause the processor to perform operations comprising: receiving a hash function from a master security server, wherein the hash function is used to verify an application installed on the device; applying the hash function to application code of the application to determine a hash result; providing the hash result to the master security server, wherein the master security server determines whether the application is verified by comparing the hash result to a stored hash result determined, by the master security server, by applying the hash function to a latest version of the application stored on the master security server; in response to a determination by the master security server that the application is unverified, receiving a notification from the master security server, wherein the notification comprises instructions for the device to automatically delete the application, and wherein the master security server sends a command to a network node instructing the network node to deny data traffic originating from the application to a destination; and in response to the notification, automatically deleting the application from the device.

13. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the operations further comprise receiving a second hash function from the master security server.

14. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 13, wherein the second hash function is used to verify a second application installed on the device.

15. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 14, wherein the operations further comprise: applying the second hash function to second application code of the second application to

determine a second hash result; providing the second hash result to the master security server, wherein the master security server determines whether the second application is verified based upon the second hash result; executing the second application thereby generating data traffic to be sent via a network to a destination; and providing, by the device, the data traffic generated by the second application to the network, wherein a network node receives the data traffic generated by the second application and allows or denies the data traffic generated by the second application access to the destination based upon a command associated with the second application received from the master security server.

16. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 13, wherein the second hash function replaces the hash function.

17. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the hash function is periodically updated by the master security server.

18. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the device comprises a smartphone.

19. The computer-readable storage medium of claim 12, wherein the device comprises a computer.
